



ZESFE

ZENJ EMPIRE SUFI FESTIVAL

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THE PROPOSAL OF ZENJ EMPIRE SUFI FESTIVAL OF 2019

INTRODUCTION

Zenj Empire Sufi festival is the first Sufi Festival which has established in the island of Zanzibar (Unguja & Pemba) which is located in the coast of East Africa. This two Islands has the population of about one million people where by Muslim population is about 95%.

Zanzibar prides itself with sunny weather and beautiful sand beaches. Zanzibar is considered as a centre of both Secular and Religious Education. Also is the centre of the foundation of Sufi activities in East Africa.

Therefore our organization has taken decision of establishing Sufi Festival in the Island of Unguja and Pemba as to give more chance for people of these two islands to show and present their talents to the locals and foreign people who are coming in these Islands as tourists and researchers.

Zenj Sufi festival established since 31st August 2009A.D with registration number 724 according to Zanzibar Society Act no 6 Of 1995A.D and the first name known as Zenj Islamic Festival and after that changed and known as Zenj Empire Sufi Festival. Also the same date another organization as a sister organization of



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Sufism activities known as **Alwahdatu-Ashawqaniyyatu-Annaqshabandiyyah** has been registered and its registration number is 725. The management of all these two organizations are the same.

Zenj Empire Sufi Festival has already prepared eight festivals continuously without missing any year from 2009 up to 2016 A.D. but in different levels according to funding we are getting from the donors and sponsors.

International sponsors and donors have donated and assisted these Sufi festival among that are Oman Consulate, Indonesia Embassy, Palestine Embassy, Iran Cultural Centre and Switzerland Embassy who became main donor in 2014 and 2015. In 2016 most of the local people and local companies and NGOs have tried their best to assist this festival.

Other local organizations who have assisted this festival are Fisherman Tour, Kendwa Rocks Hotel, SISI consulted, Marhaba Tour. Therefore we aim to do again this festival on 6th Dec-10th Dec 2017 may our Almighty God wishes by the blessings of his prophets and saints Amen.

Expected budget of the Eighth Sufi Festival of 2019

The expected budget of the Eighth Zenj Empire Sufi Festival of 2019 is which shall cost one hundred sixty six thousand three hundred and sixty two (**\$166362**)

Future long term strategic plan expenses of buying the land of five acres and building the Sufi Cultural and Educational Centre

Aims and Missions of Zenj Empire Sufi Festival

Zenj Islamic Festival has aims and missions as follows:-

-To raise awareness to the teenagers adults and elders on the importance of protecting their History and their Culture.



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- To protect the Sufi activities including Sufi Drums and Sufi Songs in Zanzibar and in the coast of East Africa.
- To raise awareness to the women to have involvement in the cultural and social activities.
- To promote peace unity and love around the World to both Muslim and Non Muslim societies.
- To promote and inspire new Sufi talents through Films, Film makers, Photos, Pictures and Sufi music's and Sufi Drums,Sufi Gathering known as Sufi Hadhra and Sufi Dhikri.
- To motivate youth to have ability of using their brains and their talents by creating different valuable things which are usefully and benefit for their daily life.
- To enable Zanzibar Islamic Films makers and others around the cost of east Africa, writers, actors, producers and directors importance of presenting and organizing themselves their professional works and think more for the benefit of themselves and for the society.
- To inspire those involved in all Islamic cultural talents as to acquire the skills they need to make the most of their talent and unlock their full creative potential
- To motivate youth to build their health by cooperating in the different exercise and sports activities and enable them to build good social health and wealth through sports and exercise.
- To educate youth means of communication skills by teaching them different languages which shall assist those to have easily communication and having easily job opportunity and the ability of using modern information technology.



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-To educate teenagers on the bad effect of using drugs, smoking cigarettes and random sexual intercourse and any other bad habits which shall destroy their future plans.

Therefore we aim to inspire individuals to clarify their overall goals within film, pictures, photos, writing books, Islamic Songs and Music's and Islamic Sports activities.

Generally Zenj Empire Sufi Festival project as a small step within a much bigger picture and not an end of this mission.

The Vision

Zenj Empire Sufi Festival is nonprofit cultural organization it has a social aims and will act as a role model and inspiration to those involved in cultural activities in its broadest sense. We aim to create networks, encourage collaboration and present opportunities for those who are serious about a career in Sufi cultural activities, irrespective of their existing experience.

Our overall vision is to create an environment which may kick start a whole new era in Sufi films ,Sufi Books, Sufi Music's ,Sufi pictures which based in the heart of Zanzibar Stone Town and other rural area of Unguja and Pemba Islands .

We wish to create an industry which will provide export opportunities and attract Sufi cultural activities to secure a long term future for new Sufi talents.



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Seven Strategic Objectives

In support of our mission we have set ourselves seven key objectives:-

1. To create involvement of youth adults and elders including men and women in the development of society activities and cultural programs.
2. To showcase Sufi culture and staging various events across the island of Zanzibar and Pemba as an annual event and promote awareness of the Sufi culture around the world among both Muslims and non Muslims.
3. To assist youth to upgrade their talents and their communication skills as to enable them to cooperate with other societies for the benefit of their future and the ability of using modern information technology.
4. To establish a fund which will support individuals to develop their Sufi Cultural talent and to promote Sufi arts including films, Sufi music and Sufi drums, Sufi arts and drawings, Sufi writers and sports among children, youths, adults, elders and disabled people.
5. To recognize notable works and achievements through **ZESFE AWARDS** for Sufi writers and poets, Sufi preachers, Sufi film makers, Sufi musicians and winners of the sporting activities and participation, creativity in high standards.
6. To reach as wide an audience as possible through the festival program by marketing the event through the media and public promotional campaigns and to promote **ZESFES'** programs and Film production.
7. To search for possible solutions to the Muslims cultural and social problems and building good understanding between Muslims and Non-Muslims societies through workshops, seminars, symposiums, Sufi writers and Sufi film makers forum and round table discussions to promote peaceful and harmonious Zanzibar society and throughout East, south and central Africa.



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ZESFES' YEARLY ACTIVITIES

In different **ZESFE** Sufi festival the organization has succeed to perform some activities among many activities which has planned this is due to limited sponsors and financial supports . In all eight festival organizations has got some shareholders who contribute small amount of money which enable to do very few activities. But in the year of 2014 and 2015 the organization has got main sponsor of this festival who is Switzerland Embassy and in 2016 local people and local companies with NGOs have tried their best to assist this sufi festival. Therefore our organization has planned in this year 2019 to have more other Sufi Festival activities may our Almighty God wishes with the blessing of the Prophets and Saints Amen.

HIGHER AUTHORITY OF ZENJ EMPIRE SUFI FESTIVAL

A-Board of Trustees

- 1-Yussuf Mshangama -Chairman of Board of Trustees
- 2- Abdulghani Abdulaziz -Deputy Chairman of Board of Trustees
- 3- Omar Yussuf Mwinyi - Secretary
- 4- Fatma Hamza Ameyr
- 5-Maryam Hemed Ali

B-Islamic Theological Council & Executive Committee

- 6-Jabir Haidar Jabir El-Farsy-President and Managing Director
- 7-Rabii Rashid Rabii-Deputy President and Deputy Managing Director
- 8-Salmanfaris Haidar Jabir- Secretary General
- 9-Said Mohd Hemed -Deputy -Secretary General
- 10-Jaafar Mohd Issa- Chief Accountant

MEETINGS SHALL CONDUCTED BEFORE THE FESTIVAL

Over ten meetings shall be expected to be conducted for the preparation of the Sufi festival of 2017 and different agendas shall be discussed including ways of getting financial support, period of the festival, days of the festival, programs of the festival, venue of the festival, honorable guests, invited guests from other countries, invitation of Ngos and local people, embassies, consulates and



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International organizations, choosing festival supervisors and leaders of each committees.

The organization also has succeed to do it second members general meeting which occur every after five year. This meeting has been done on Wednesday 18th December 2015 and members of the bodies have been elected with the amendment of some Articles of the organization constitution including the translation of letter E and add letter S which seen in the emblem and from that date shall be known as Zenj Empire Sufi Festival (**ZESFE**) instead of Zenj Islamic Festival. Therefore election of the leaders of the councils of the Zenj Empire Sufi festival (ZESFE) of 2015 has been conducted in successfully way.

AIM OF THE FESTIVAL

The aim of the festival is to give awareness to Zanzibar society on Islamic culture and Sufi activities and creating peace between Muslim and Non Muslim societies.

THEME “MOTO” OF OUR FESTIVAL OF 2019

“UNITY AND PEACE THROUGH SUFI CULTURAL ACTIVITIES”

FESTIVAL ACTIVITIES WHICH SHALL BEEN CONDUCTED IN 2019

There shall be different activities in this festival among that are:-

- Opening Ceremony of the Sufi Festival*
- Women Mauled Panorama*
- *Men Mauled Panorama and Sufi Songs and Sufi Drums Exhibition*
- Zaffa as Sufi Parade in Narrow Streets of the Old Stone Town*
- *Extra Sufi Songs and Sufi Drums Exhibition*
- *Films Exhibition*
- Pictures and Photos Exhibition*
- Books Exhibitions*



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-The seminar and symposium of Immunization of Swahili Sufi Culture, history and Peace.

PERIOD OF THE FESTIVAL OF THE YEAR 2019

The Festival shall start on 11th Dec up to 15th Dec 2019 .The opening ceremony shall be on 12th Dec 2019 in Old Arab Fort at Forodhani Zanzibar .The Opening ceremony shall start at 8:30 p.m -11:30 p.

PLACE OF VENUE

The festival shall be occurred in different places that are:-

1-Old Arab Fort

2-Forodhani Garden

3-Sultan Palace Museum at Forodhani street

4-Mnara wa Mapinduzi at Michenzani area

5-Outside Ismailiya Jamat at Hurumzi street

6-Bamnara Mosque at Malindi Street

7-Malindi Jumaa Mosque at Mizingani Malindi Street.

8-In Hamamni Secondary School

ACTIVITIES WHICH SHALL BE EXPECTED TO BE DONE IN THE SUFI FESTIVAL

1-Opening Ceremony in the Old Arab Fort:-i) The function of opening ceremony shall be held on 7th Dec 20017 at 8:30p.m-11:30p.m.Different dignitaries and celebrities with other guests from different countries shall be expected to attend in this function. Also different Sufi groups of sufi songs and sufi drums shall be presented in this opening day ceremony.



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C)ZAFFA KNOWN SUFI PARADE IN NARROW STREET OF ZANZIBAR STONE TOWN

Another activity we shall expect to have in this festival is the ZAFFA known as Sufi Parade which shall occurred in the narrow street of Zanzibar Stone Town. Some members of Sufi drums and sufi songs from different areas of Zanzibar shall be cooperated in this function. Actually this function always is to attractive to the tourists, guests and locals and always create happy gathering to all types of people including children young's teenagers adults and elders people. The city becomes active and alive during this activity of Sufi Parade.

D-) SYMPOSIUM OF PEACE, CULTURE AND REMBERANCE OF SUFI SCHOLARS

The Zen Empire Sufi Festival ZESFE also every year prepare the symposium of peace ,culture and remembrance of Islamic Sufi Scholars of East South and Central Africa especially of Zanzibar. Therefore this year has aimed to have this symposium and seminar on 8th Dec and 9th Dec 2017 this seminar of symposium also discussing the impact of Sheikh Abdallah Saleh Farsy with his noble work of translating the whole Qur-an in Swahili language and also Sheikh Hassan bin Umeyr Shirazi with his noble work of wrting Arabic religion books in Arabic language .This two days symposium we expecting to be attended with different scholars from different areas of East Africa and around the world. This Seminar we expecting to be held in Maru Maru Hotel.

E) THE SUFI ISLAMIC MAULED GATHERING

The organization of Zenj Empire Sufi festival has aimed to prepare the gathering of Sufi Mauled which different sufi groups get chance to read their sufi songs and read sufi poems in traditional ways. Always this gathering occurred in the last day of this Festival at 8:30 p.m up to 11:30 p.m on 10th Dec 2017 and after that there is continuation of sufi groups from different villages and Islands of Zanzibar up to



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dawn time. This sufi gathering is aimed to preserve the ral sufi activities in the sufi celebration when occur like the celebration of the birthday of the Prophet Muhammad (s.a.w.w) and wedding celebration of the Sufi people in the East Coast areas.

B) Women Mauled Panorama shall be held at Hamamni Secondary School Hall

The women mauled Panorama is the panorama which gives women to present their Sufi talents and to show the audience their ability of presenting sufi songs and sufi drums also to participate in the Sufi festival as very important part of this festival. Also different women sufi groups were invited from different areas of Unguja and Pemba. Also in the year 2015 the ZESFE organization has invited women sufi group from Mayotte Island. In this year also we aimed to invite them again also the group from Lamu Island.

D) ZIARA OF SHEIKH ABDULAZIZI BIN ABDULGHANI BIN FAQIH TWAHIR AL-AMAWIY THE SECOND CHIEF QADHI OF ZANZIBAR IN 19TH CENTURY AT BAMNARA MOSQUE AT MALINDI STREET IN ZANZIBAR STONE TOWN

Another activitiy which the organization is preparing is the activitiy known as ZIARA it means the remembrance of the Sufi Scholars of East South and Central Africa. Sheikh Abdulaziz bin Abdulghani bin Faqih Twahir Al-Amawiy was the second Chief Qadhi of Zanzibar in the time of Sayyid Majid bin Said Albsaidy .He was taking this position after resignation of his teacher Sheikh Muhyidin bin Abdi Sheikh Alkahtwani. Sheikh Abdulaziz bin Abdulghani is the descendent the third caliphate of Sayyidna Othman bin Afan (R.A) after his resignation his son Sheikh Burhan bin Abdulaziz Al-Amawiy was buried beside his father outside Bamnara Mosque Malindi Zanzibar. Different members of Sufi groups from Tanganyika, Uganda ,Kenya and different areas of Unguja and Pemba.



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E)THE REMERANNCE OF ALHABIB AHMAD BIN SUMEYT THE FOURTH CHIEF QADHI OF ZANZIBAR AT MALINDI JUMAA MASQUE ZAZNIBAR

Also the attendants and members of Zenj Empire Sufi Festival always visiting the grave of Alhabib Ahmad bin Sumeyt the fourth chief Qadhi of Zanzibar during the Zaffa day Sufi parade and making prayer for the blessing of the Sufi Scholars and teaching the attendants invited guests the important of Sufi Scholars and preserving heir history, their noble work of writing religious books in Arabic Language and Swahili Language. Therefore also this year 2017 the organization aimed to have this activity as usual.

Also remembrance of Sheikh Muhyidin bin Abdi Sheikh Alkahtwani, Sheikh Twahir bin Abdulrahman Al-Amawiy,Alhabib Ahmad bin Abibakr bin Sumeyt, Sheikh Ali bin Muhammad Al-Abbas Alhashimy, Alhabib Jaafar Alwahtwi, Sheikh Said bin Dahman,Sayyid Ahmad bin Hussein,Sheikh Jabir bin Saleh Alfarsy and Sheikh Haidar bin Jabir Alfarsy.This activity shall be inside the Malindi Jumaa mosque at 4:30p.m-6:00p.m was held on 9th st Dec 2017A.D.

The remembrance speech and history of the sufi scholars with special prayers to the past sufi scholars shall be deliver. Only men were attendant in this activity due to the difficulty of the place of women inside the mosque. Also most of the attendants were more attractive with this function and they said it is very important to have a remembrance day of the Sufi scholars like this because is giving the new generation the understanding of their past Sufi scholars of East South and Central of Africa.

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F)- Film Documentary and Annual Members General Meeting at Maru Maru Hotel behind Old Arab Fort at Forordhani

In the Maru Maru hotel these activities shall be expected to be done :-

i)The organization every year doing The Members Annual meeting and every after five years prepare the Members General meeting which has been already held on 11th Dec 2019 at 7:00p.m-10:00p.m and new leaders have been elected by the members of General Members Meeting. Therefore this year 2019 A.D also annual meeting of the Zenj Empire Sufi Festival shall be held on 6th Dec 2019 at 7.00p.m – 9:00p.m

ii)The two days film documentary shall be arranged on 11th Dec-12th Dec 2019.The Palestine Embassy and Indonesia Embassy have sent their documentary films.The documentary films were four two from Palestine Embassy and two from Indonesia Embassy. Also Indonesia Embassy donate seven hundreds thousands (700,000TSH) for the activities of the film documentary.

G)- EXTRA SUFI SONGS AND DRUMS

The extra Sufi songs and drums shall be arranged in the open and public places for the aim of reaching the tourists and local people who shall not able to attend other functions and also to advertise and marketing the Sufi Festival activities. This activity shall be expected to be done in Forordhani Garden and in front of Al-Islamailiya Jamat Hurumzi Street on 13th Dec 2019 and from 4:30p.m -6:30pm

INVITED SUFI GROUPS GUESTS AND ATTENDANTS

In the festival different invited sufi groups from inside the country and outside the country example from Dar-esalam ,Tanga , Lamu Pate Siu ,Kizingiti ,Faza and Tundwa shall be invited to present their sufi talents to the audience .Also different countries shall be invited to send to us their documentary films and other films like Turkey, Indonesia, Palestine ,Iran, Oman ,Kuwait, United Arab Emirates, Egypt



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Saudi Arabia ,United States of America ,Switzerland and other Nordic Countries like Denmark, Norway ,Finland and Sweden .

BOOKS AND OLD ITEM EXHIBITION

The organization every year is preparing the books and old item exhibition. Different old books and new books of different topic shall be presented like religious books history books, hand writing materials, old coins and some old items among the things which shall be shown to the people. Some books organization are giving free to the people which the organization. Different countries and organization are invited to send to us their books from their authors for the exhibition. This Exhibition is expected to be held inside the old Arab Fort. The exhibition shall start on 11th Dec -16th Dec 2019

Most of the people and tourists from different countries around the world are expected to attend in this festival.

OUR NEEDED ASSISTANCE AND DONATIONS OF EIGHTH FESTIVAL

The organization need one hundred thousand (180,000USD) to able to implement and complete all festival activities. This expense including these items:-

Office Equipments including five laptops four office cabinets one round table four office table ,one safe cabin, one fridge and twenty office chairs, one photocopy machine, two printers with scanners which shall cost thousand dollars (\$5000)

Recording materials like two modern video camera and still camera, two projectors two flat TV , two DVD shall cost five thousand dollars \$5000,

Transportation including two mini bus and two four wheel cars for assisting to fulfill the objective of the festival shall cost twenty thousand dollars (\$20,000).



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Future needed assistance and donation

-To buy the five acres land which shall cost \$50,000

-To build the Sufi Cultural Centre with the Sufi Museum and Library which shall cost six hundred thousand (\$600,000)

SUMMARY OF THE AIMS, OBJECTIVES EXPENSES OF ZESFE

The zenj Empire Sufi Festival aimed:-

-To do the festival of 2017 this shall cost **\$166362.5**

-To buy building in the Old Stone Town for the centre and office of Zenj Empire Sufi Festival which shall cost \$400,00 renovation \$100,000 furniture \$50,000 and office Equipments \$50,0000 grand total shall be **\$600,000.**

TOTAL EXPESES FOR ALL FESTIVAL ACTIVITIES OF 2017		
S/NO	ACTIVITY	
1	Office Equipments	25650
2	Opening ceremony	8706.278
	Seminar of Peace & Culture	6,929.25
4	Film Documentary	7650.694
6	Picture Exhibition	11743.95
7	Book Exhibition	4525.336
8	Tajwid Competition	16541
9	Men Sufi Mauled	6681.20
10	Women Sufi Mauled	6681.20
11	Zaffa Sufi Parade	5473.655
12	Sufi Fun Run	5473.655
3	Closing Ceremony	8706.278
	Allowences for	
14	Supervisors	51600
		166362.5



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CONCLUSION

- The organization aimed to have the Sufi festival of 2019 which shall cost one hundred sixty six thousand three hundred and sixty two(**\$166362**)
- To build the Naqshabandi Sufi cultural and Educational centre which **one million eight hundred thousand fifty nine thousands six hundred and fifty six (\$1859656)** as to full fill its objectives.
- After implementing and conducted its festival activities its need to sit and analysis the successful of the festival activities of the year 2019 and do the corrections of all mistakes and errors occurred in this year as to get better implementation of nest year.
- Also the leaders and members of the organization they must be serious and hardworking for their responsibilities and not to leave all responsibilities for only one to three persons.
- Embassies and International Organizations should take their roles of assisting this festival and to increase their donations as to able to reach to their aims and goal.
- Local donors should take their role to ensure that they are assisting and giving enough financial support as to enable Zeif organization to fulfill their aims and goal.
- Local people should feel this festival has big important for them and not only for foreigners and leaders of the organization and it is important for Islam to preserve its history and its culture



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Therefore the organization is requesting all donors and members and other people who are interesting in assisting organization to fulfill its aims and its goal. Also Zeif organization is asking our Almighty Allah S.W to assist all donors, members and any person who assist this festival our Almighty Allah shall give them better future, happiness with their families and good ending of their lives Insha-Allah amen.

Lastly we ask our Almighty God Allah with the blessing of the Prophet Muhammad peace and mercy be upon him to assist us to fulfill our objective **Amin.**

Written and Prepared by

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26th Sept 2019.

IN ALLAH WE SEEK FOR HIS ASSITANCE AMEN



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